

However, the most irritating bit of this incident is, when my neighbour found out, and just *had* to boast of his foresight when buying his PC—he'd bought a spike guard and a surge-protected UPS. Very reluctantly, I have to admit he was right.

If your PC is more than just something you use to check e-mail (in my case it's actually the tool I use to earn a living), you need to make sure it's safe in every way possible. If you don't have a surge protector (UPS, spike guard, or both) between your PC and the electricity mains in your house / office, cease, desist, and go and get one right this instant!

Back It Up

Once I decided that I would do everything possible to safeguard my data, I started looking for even more redundancy. Although I now use RAID at work, I decided that at home, since I already have multiple hard drives—80 GB, 120 GB, and 250 GB—there's really no point in buying a fourth drive of one of those capacities and setting up RAID. If you have only one hard drive, and your data is vital, getting another drive and setting up RAID is still the preferred option though.

The next-best solution to RAID is to use backup software. With RAID, you can safeguard everything, including your Windows installation, from drive crashes. Backup software, however, cannot protect Windows, but will help make sure all the data you want protected is backed up. Apart from just making another copy of your valuable data, backup software has become a lot *smarter*.

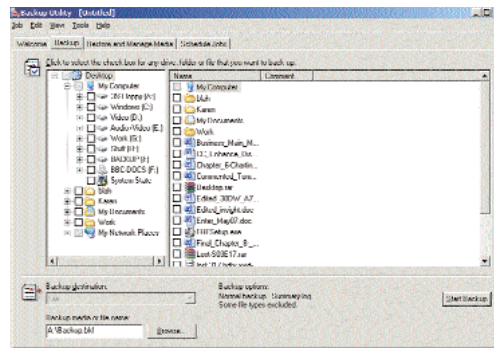
Any half-decent backup software should offer incremental backups

For just basic use, you can use Windows' own backup utility. Go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > System Tools > Backup**. You will see the Backup or Restore Wizard. Just follow the easy steps to back up your data regularly. If you want a few advanced features, when the Wizard starts, uncheck the "Always start in wizard mode" box and click on the Advanced Mode link. Here you will find advanced options that will let you specify the folders to back up, and even set a schedule for backups. It's really easy to do, so I'm not going into the details. There is a lot of third-party backup software also available, most of them paid, that will let you do more. If you choose to buy such software, you should look for the following features.

Incremental Backups: Any half-decent software should offer incremental backups. This means that if you set the software to back up, say, the Documents and Settings folder—instead of just copying the entire folder to your backup drive, it should only look for new or changed files and copy those. This helps reduce the time that the backup takes.

Scheduled Backups:

If you have to manually take every backup, why do you need software?



For simple backup jobs, use the Windows Backup tool and use Scheduled Tasks to automate them



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Technical Specifications		Main Features	
Model	PTV4218	• The Premium Image Truly Gem-Garden From 1000 To 4000	
Resolution	1024x768 (DVI-D)	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Resolution	640x480 (VGA) / 800x600 (DVI-D)	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Contrast	800:1	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Light source	300W UHP (Ultra High Pressure) Lamp	• 100% Screen Display Function	
LAMP LIFE	20000 HOURS	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Power/Connector	110V (Auto) (Auto frequency detect)	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Power	110W (ATX POWER)	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Projection distance	1.2m (3.9ft)	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Projection dimension	30" x 20"	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Input	TV, AV, PC, D-VIDEO	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Output	Audio, S-Video, Composite	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Projection	NTSC, PAL, SECAM	• 100% Screen Display Function	
Weight	2.5kg	• 100% Screen Display Function	
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